

Meeting cheat-sheet · Columbia Law professor

Glance, don't read. The 7 beats + your anchor questions.

1 **Open** ~30s

Thank him, note it's short, frame what you want — so he knows where to aim.

“Appreciate the time — I want to be useful with it. I'd love your read on how someone with my background breaks into football, and where the real doors are.”

2 **You — lead with Trak** ~90s

Two lines: just finished Columbia Law. Pivot fast to Trak (what it is + any traction). Goal: football operations or governance, open to US and Europe. Trak = headline, law degree = support. Don't recite your CV.

3 **His read** the bulk

Hand him the wheel. Listen > talk. Take notes. Follow his threads.

“With a law degree AND a football product, where's my strongest wedge — operations, or the legal/governance side?”

“Football Development & Technical vs Revenue Operations — where's the need, and the fit?”

4 **Sequencing — your anchor** key

Surface the visa timeline honestly, then ask him to help you prioritize. Don't skip this one.

“My US work authorization runs to about February 2027. Would you push the US route now, lean into Europe where I can work freely, or both — and how would you sequence it?”

5 **Soft network ask** near end

Ask for a conversation, not a job. Give him an easy out — that's what makes a yes likely.

“Without putting you on the spot — who should I be learning from, and if it ever felt right, would you point me toward one of them?”

6 **Trak angle** if time

Plant that you've got optionality.

“Is Trak more useful as a credential that gets me hired, or a product to pitch to federations directly?”

7 **Close — make it effortless**

Thank him, restate anything he offered, make helping a one-click job.

“Hugely helpful. Can I send a one-pager on me and Trak you could forward? And what's the best way to stay in touch?”

KEEP IN MIND THE WHOLE TIME

Listen more than you talk · Name the visa honestly but late (context for sequencing, never the opener) · Project optionality, not need